but rather aimed at safeguarding our respective interests, India's and Russia's interests. In our dealings, we cause no harm to others, and I believe that leaders from other countries should appreciate this. As for India's purchases or purchase of energy resources from Russia, well, I would like to note and have already mentioned this publicly once—the United States itself still buys nuclear fuel from Russia for its own nuclear power plants. That is also fuel—uranium for the reactors operating in the United States. If the US has the right to buy our fuel, why shouldn't India have the same privilege? This question deserves thorough examination, and we stand ready to discuss it, including with President Trump.

Q. How would you characterise President Trump?
A. I never give character assessments about my colleagues—neither those I've worked with in the past nor current leaders of individual states. These assessments should be made by citizens who vote for their leader during elections.

> **"We are insisting on fulfilling promises pledged to us in the '90s: no NATO expansion eastward. Ukraine believes joining NATO would benefit it. We say the military-political alliance threatens our security"**



Q. Trump has weaponised tariffs and done so against India. How do you think India and Russia should be handling Donald Trump and the US administration?
A. You know, he pursues his own policy, and he has advisors—his decisions aren't made from thin air. He has advisors who believe that implementing such tariff policies, involving the imposition of additional duties on trade partners, ultimately benefits the US economy. He is acting in good faith, I presume. We have never engaged in such practices, do not do so now, and have no intention of doing so in the future. Our economy is open. We hope that, in the end, all violations of World Trade Organisation regulations will be rectified.

Q. You just had an important meeting with two US interlocutors over Ukraine. What was its outcome?
A. It's premature to discuss that now. It lasted five hours. Frankly, even I grew weary of it—five hours is too much. However, it was necessary because it was a very productive conversation, as what our American colleagues presented was, in one way or another, based on our prior agreements made before my meeting with President Trump in Alaska. We had discussed these very issues, to some extent, at the meeting in Anchorage. However, what the Americans brought us this time was truly new; we hadn't seen it before. Therefore, we had to go through practically every point, which is why it took so much time. So, it was a meaningful, highly specific and substantive conversation.

Q. Were there any specific points of disagreement?
A. Yes, such issues were raised, we discussed them. But this is a complex task and a challenging mission that President Trump took upon himself—fair enough, I say without irony, because achieving consensus among conflicting parties is no easy task. But President Trump, truly, I believe, he sincerely tries to do this. We went through each point again, let me reiterate this. Sometimes we said, "yes, we can discuss this, but with that one we cannot agree." That was how the work proceeded. To say now what exactly doesn't suit us or where we could possibly agree seems premature, since it might disrupt the very mode of operation that President Trump is trying to establish. But that's what they do—shuttle diplomacy. They spoke with Ukrainian representatives, then with Europeans, came here, had another meeting with Ukrainians and Europeans. I think